



Issue No. 10

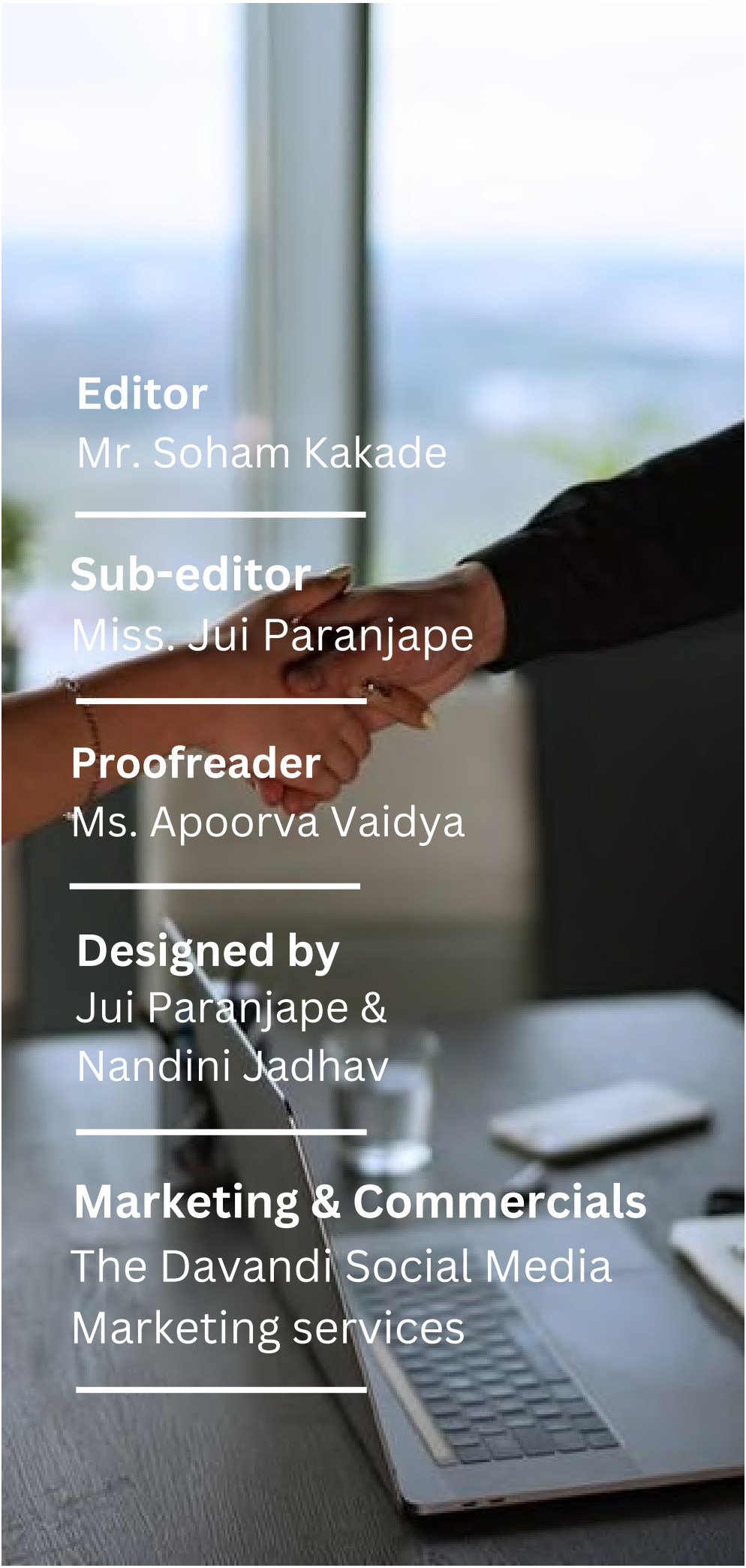
May 2025

**True Friends are Always
Together in Spirit...**

**Friends Are the Family
You Choose.**

THE LANGUAGE GAZETTE

MEET THE TEAM



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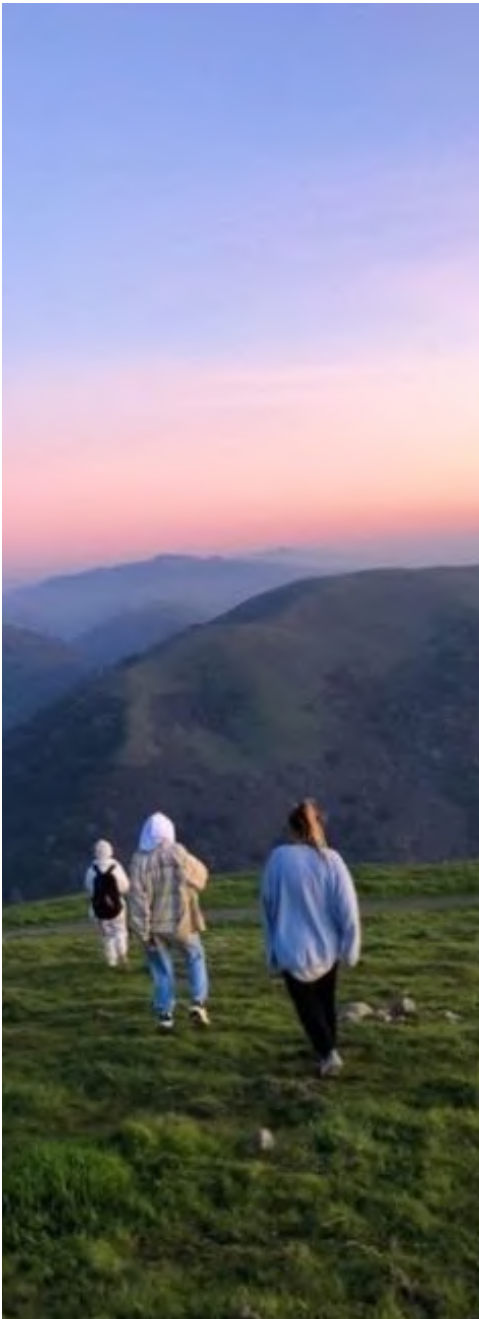


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Editorial

New Words, New Friends: The Beautiful Surprise of Belonging Abroad

By Soham Kakade
Director, Ewan Business Solutions

You never forget your first real conversation in a foreign language.

Not the textbook dialogues, not the grammar drills. A real conversation—with a real person, in a new place, where your effort to connect turns into something unexpectedly warm: friendship.

For anyone who has studied a new language, there comes a moment when words begin to mean more than just vocabulary. They become bridges. Bridges that cross culture, distance, and sometimes even awkward silences. And on the other side of that bridge, often waiting with a curious smile or a hearty laugh, is a new friend.

There's something incredibly rewarding about making a friend in a foreign country simply because you took the time to learn their language—or even just tried. Locals notice it. A halting “Hola” in Spain, a polite “Konnichiwa” in Japan, or a cheerful “Salut!” in France can spark joy in a stranger's eyes. It tells them, I'm not just here to visit. I want to connect.



That tiny bit of effort often snowballs into conversations, shared meals, invitations to local events, and deeper cultural exchange than any tour guide could offer. You laugh over mispronunciations, trade stories about growing up in different worlds, and slowly, your idea of “foreign” changes. It becomes familiar. Personal.

Language learners often talk about fluency. But what they don’t always mention is the thrill of forming your first friendship in that new language. It’s not just about communication—it’s about chemistry, humor, patience, and the unspoken joy of discovering someone whose life looks nothing like yours, yet somehow fits perfectly beside it.

These friendships come with countless benefits. Your language skills improve faster than in any classroom. You pick up local slang, gestures, expressions—the things that make a language live. Your new friends help you navigate social customs, introduce you to regional food, music, even the best place for late-night snacks. And when homesickness creeps in, they’re often the ones who remind you why you came in the first place.

But perhaps the greatest gift is emotional. In a place where you expected to feel lost, you find belonging. You realize you don’t need perfect grammar to form a connection—just curiosity, kindness, and the courage to try.

So whether you’re a language student, an expat, a traveler, or just someone intrigued by the world beyond your own, remember this: languages aren’t just tools. They’re invitations. And sometimes, all it takes is a single word to turn a stranger into a friend.

EWAN INSIGHTS

My Experience at EWAN



Being an HR Manager and Vendor Manager at Ewan Business Solutions was a very enriching experience that made me aware of working at the interface of people management and global cooperation. Being a firm in the business of language translation and localization, the success of Ewan depended just as much on both an excellent in-house team and global vendor network.

My role as an HR Manager for in-house recruitment in different departments like the Marketing Team, Projects Team, and Business Development Team involved me in developing personalized recruitment plans for every team. Every team had unique skill sets and cultural dynamics, and it was challenging for me to develop personalized recruitment plans. Right from screening candidates to induction, I was eager to ensure that we recruited professionals who had not only the appropriate technical skills but also the company's values and team-based work culture.

As Vendor Manager, I collaborated with experts from around the world for language translation, localization, interpretation, and market research services. The work required accuracy, cultural awareness, and successful negotiation.

I also collaborated very closely with the internal teams to ensure vendor services were well integrated into our business processes.

Balancing these twin roles has increased my strategic thinking, cross-cultural communication, and organizational planning. Working for Ewan Business Solutions was not just enriching on a professional front but also fulfilling on a personal front as it allowed me to leave a legacy on a company that bridges language and cultural differences on a global level.

Mr. Krishna Asawa
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UNE LANGUE PARTAGÉE, UNE FAMILLE RETROUVÉE

Je me souviens encore de mes années de diplôme à Techno India, Salt Lake — les couloirs animés, les pauses chai, les travaux de groupe, tout ça. C'est là que j'ai rencontré Francis. Il venait d'Afrique. Honnêtement, au début, on ne parlait pas beaucoup. Il semblait calme, réservé. Je remarquais qu'il avait un peu de mal avec l'anglais, alors je ne voulais pas le forcer à entrer dans des conversations inconfortables. On se contentait d'échanger des sourires. C'était tout. Pendant les deux premières semaines, on ne se parlait presque pas — juste des hochements de tête polis et une compagnie silencieuse. Mais étrangement, j'avais l'impression qu'il y avait quelque chose de plus chez lui. Il dégageait cette vibe de frère aîné — calme, mature, posé.

Puis, un après-midi, pendant un travail de groupe, j'ai dit quelque chose en français. Ça m'est sorti sans y penser. Et le regard qu'il a eu,

son visage qui s'est illuminé — je ne l'oublierai jamais. Il m'a répondu en français, clair et fluide. On s'est juste arrêtés, puis on a éclaté de rire.

Tout ce temps, on avait une langue en commun et on ne le savait même pas. Ce n'était pas juste un ami — avec le temps, je l'ai vu comme quelqu'un qui m'a aidé pendant ces années universitaires, comme un grand frère. Je ne l'avais jamais anticipé, mais c'est arrivé.

Après ça, le silence a disparu. On a commencé à parler tous les jours — surtout en français. C'était naturel. Il a commencé à partager des choses sur son pays, le choc culturel, la nourriture qui lui manquait. Je l'écoutais et je partageais aussi mes propres expériences. Il n'était pas bruyant ni flamboyant, mais il avait toujours cette façon de me guider, de me calmer quand tout devenait trop. C'est là que j'ai commencé à le voir comme plus qu'un ami — il était devenu un grand frère.



que je n'aurais jamais imaginé rencontrer à l'université.

Même après l'obtention de notre diplôme, on se parle toujours — principalement sur Facebook maintenant. Un “Bonjour” par-ci, une mise à jour de la vie par-là. C’est simple, mais ça veut beaucoup dire. C’est fou comme une seule langue partagée a rapproché deux étrangers venus de mondes différents, presque comme une famille. Je me souviens encore de ces moments où on parlait en français de temps en temps quand on se retrouvait. Même maintenant, bien qu’on soit séparés par des kilomètres, on dirait qu’on est toujours là, à discuter ensemble...



A SHARED LANGUAGE, A FOUND FAMILY



I still remember my graduation days at Techno India, Salt Lake — busy corridors, chai breaks, group assignments, all that. That's when I met Francis. He was from Africa. Honestly, at first, we didn't talk much. He seemed quiet, kept to himself. I noticed he struggled a bit with English, so I didn't want to push him into uncomfortable conversations. We just exchanged smiles. That was it. For the first two weeks, we barely spoke — just polite nods and silent company. But weirdly enough, I felt there was more to him. He gave off this elder-brother vibe — calm, mature, grounded.

Then one afternoon, during a group task, I ended up saying something in French. Just slipped out. And the way his face lit up — I'll never forget that. He replied in French, clear and fluent. We both just paused, then burst out laughing.

All that time, we'd had a whole language in common and didn't even know. He wasn't just a friend — over time, I started to see him as someone who helped me through those college days, like an older brother. I never expected that, but it happened.

After that, the silence was gone. We started talking daily — in French mostly. It just felt easy. He started sharing about his home, the culture shock, the food he missed. I'd listen and share my own things too. He wasn't loud or flashy, but always had this way of guiding me, calming me down when things got too much. That's when I started seeing him as more than a friend — he felt like an elder brother I never expected to find in college.



Even after graduation, we still talk — mostly on Facebook now. A "Bonjour" here, a life update there. It's simple, but it means a lot. Funny how one shared language brought two strangers from different worlds a little closer — like family. I still remember how we used to talk in French every now and then when we caught up. Even now, even though we're miles apart, it feels like we're still sitting together, chatting...

Ms. . Twisha Ray
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POZDRAV SVIM JEZIKOSLOVCIMA

Moje ime je Peter Harca, ja sam slobodni prevoditelj sa sjedištem u Hrvatskoj.

Želio bih podijeliti svoje iskustvo u tome kako aplikacija Google prevoditelj može pomoći u stvaranju međukulturnih prijateljstava i također, može razbiti jezičnu barijeru.

Hrvatska je posljednjih godina doživjela priliv migrantskih radnika, uglavnom iz Indije, Nepala i Bangladeša.

U gradu u kojem živim u sjeverozapadnoj Hrvatskoj, ja i moja obitelj smo išli u šetnju u subotu poslijepodne, a onda smo naišli na skupinu mladih radnika migranata.

Budući da sam dvojezičan, pozdravljao sam ih na engleskom jeziku, koje su

razumjeli i odgovorili .

Želio sam se pridružiti svojoj obitelji u razgovoru, koja može govoriti samo hrvatski.

Dakle, imajući mobilni telefon pri ruci, koristio sam aplikaciju Google prevoditelj kako bih pokrenuo dijalog.

Od prvog pozdrava na engleskom, pitao sam ih iz koje zemlje dolaze . "Bangladeš", rekli su mi.

Pitao sam ih : "Koji jezik se tamo govori?" "Bengalski", bio je odgovor.

U redu, to rečeno, odabrao sam ikonu hrvatskog jezika i bengalsku ikonu u aplikaciji Google prevoditelj.

Moja ih je supruga pitala na hrvatskom, kakvu vrstu zaposlenja imaju. I naravno , pitanje je preneseno na bengalski. Pomoću ove metode tekao je dijalog. Rekli su nam da rade u lokalnoj tvornici, šivajući odjeću za vojsku. To je bio naš prvi kontakt. Susreli smo se s njima još jedan dan, koji je ovaj put bio prilično oblačno. Ponudili smo im da nas prate u lokalni kafić, ponuda je prihvaćena.

Tijekom našeg razgovora pitali smo ih : "Kako im je obitelj kod kuće?" ali je prevedeno kao: "što tvoja žena kuha kod kuće?" To je potaknulo smijeh između dviju strana.

Došlo je vrijeme da se vrate u svoju domovinu, ali ne zaboravljajući naše srdačne razgovore, razmijenili smo brojeve mobitela i do danas se dopisujemo s njima.

Sve to zahvaljujući pomoći aplikacije Google prevoditelj.



GREETINGS ALL FELLOW LINGUISTS



Saturday afternoon, were we came across a group of young migrant workers. Being bilingual, I greeted them in English, which they understood and replied back. I wanted to join my family into the conversation, who can only speak Croatian. So, having a mobile phone on hand, I used the Google translator application to initiate a dialogue.

From my initial greeting in English, I asked them from what country they came from.

"Bangladesh", I was told. I then asked them "which language is spoken there"?

"Bengali", was the answer. Okay, that being said, I selected the Croatian language icon and also the Bengali icon in the Google translator application. My wife asked them in Croatian, what type of employment do they have. And sure enough, the question was conveyed to

My name is Peter Harca, I'm a Croatian based freelance translator. I would like to share my experience in how the Google translator application can help in forming cross cultural friendships and also break down the language barrier.

Croatia has seen an influx of migrant workers in recent years, coming mostly from India, Nepal and Bangladesh. In the town where I live in North-Western Croatia, me and my family were going for a stroll on a



them in Bengali. So using this method the dialogue flowed. We were told that they are working in a local factory, sewing garments for the army.

So that was our initial contact. We came across them another day, which was this time rather overcast. We offered them to accompany us to the local café, the offer was accepted.



During the course of our conversation, we asked them "how are their family doing back home"? but it was translated as, "what is your wife cooking back home"?

It initiated laughter between the two parties. The time came for them to return back to their homeland, but not forgetting our cordial conversations, we exchanged our mobile phone numbers and have been corresponding with them to this day.

All this thanks to the help of the Google translator application.

Mr. Peter Harca
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Baner, Pune

Time: 4.00 P.M. to 6 P.M.



भाषा, संकल्पना आणि संस्कृती

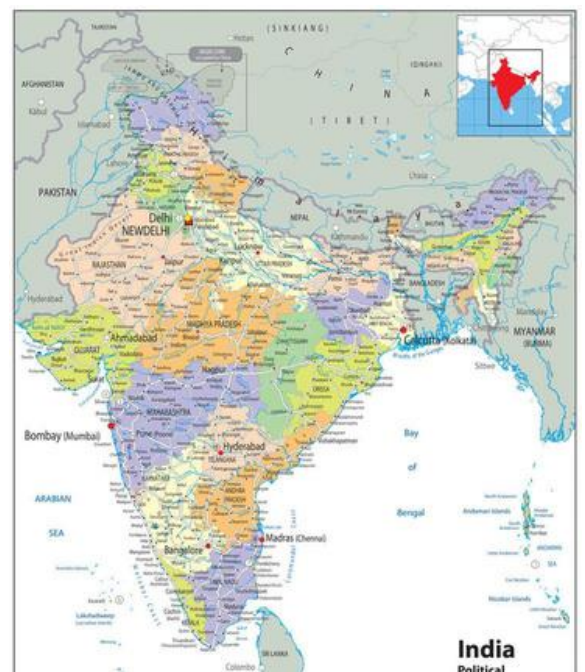
भाषेतला भाव आणि अभाव

भाषेत शब्दांचं महत्त्व किती आहे हे आपल्याला माहीत आहे. शब्दात व्यक्त होणारे भाव आपण रोजच्या संभाषणातून, भाषणातून, विशेषतः कवितेतून किंवा गाण्यातून अनुभवत असतो. मराठीमध्ये 'भावगीत' हा गाण्याचा प्रकार किती लोकप्रिय आहे! शब्दांचा प्रभाव किती असतो हेही आपण जाणतोच. काही शब्द सुखावणारे तर काही बाणासारखे बोचणारे असतात. शब्दातल्या भावाप्रमाणे शब्दाची पत, शब्दाचा पोत, वजन, किंमत असते. त्याला अनुसरून लोक शब्दांचा उपयोग करत असतात.

भाषा आणि संस्कृती

भाषा आणि संस्कृती यांचं अतूट नातं आहे. प्रत्येक भाषेला तिचं म्हणून एक व्यक्तित्व असतं आणि भाषेतला प्रत्येक शब्द संदर्भांनी संपृक्त असतो.

शब्दांना राजकारण, धर्म, धर्मकारण, इतिहास, भूगोल, हवामान, परंपरा, चालीरीती, रूढी, सणवार, इत्यादींचे अनेक संदर्भ असतात. 'आमच्या देव्हा-यात बरेच देव आहेत.' हे बहुवचानामधलं वाक्य ब-याच परभाषकांना विचित्र वाटतं, कारण ते वेगवेगळे देव मानत नाहीत. 'परवा त्याचा दहावा होता.' 'उद्या मला तेराव्याला बोलावलं आहे.' ह्या वाक्यांना रूढी, संस्कृती आणि संस्कारांचा संदर्भ आहे. आपल्याकडे एका रंगाचं नावच मोरपंखी आहे, दुस-याचं डाळिंबी आहे. एका पक्ष्याला आपण 'हळद्या' (Oriole) म्हणतो. रंगाचं किंवा पक्ष्याचं हे नाव हे संस्कृतिनिष्ठच आहे. 'भगवा' म्हटलं तर आपल्याला काय आठवेल? सर्व प्रथम भगवा झोंडा. शिवाजी, स्वराज्य. शेंदरी म्हटलं तर शेंदूर लावलेला मारुती आठवेल. 'केशरी' म्हटलं तर केशराचा भात, केशराचं दुध आठवेल. आणि ह्या जोड्या आपण बदलू शकत नाही. केशरी मारुती, भगवा भात आणि शेंदरी झोंडा असं आपण वापरत नाही. तिरंगा, वाळवण, कमळ, निरांजन, दुर्वा, माया, समाधी, वात्सल्य अशा सर्व शब्दांना संस्कृतीशी निगडित अनेक संदर्भ असतात. अशा संकल्पना इतर भाषांमध्ये शब्दांकित झालेल्या असतीलच असं नाही. 'वात्सल्य' म्हणजे 'आईचं मुलांच्या प्रती प्रेम' - एखाद्या परभाषेमध्ये 'वात्सल्य'चं असं वर्णन करून सांगावं लागेल.

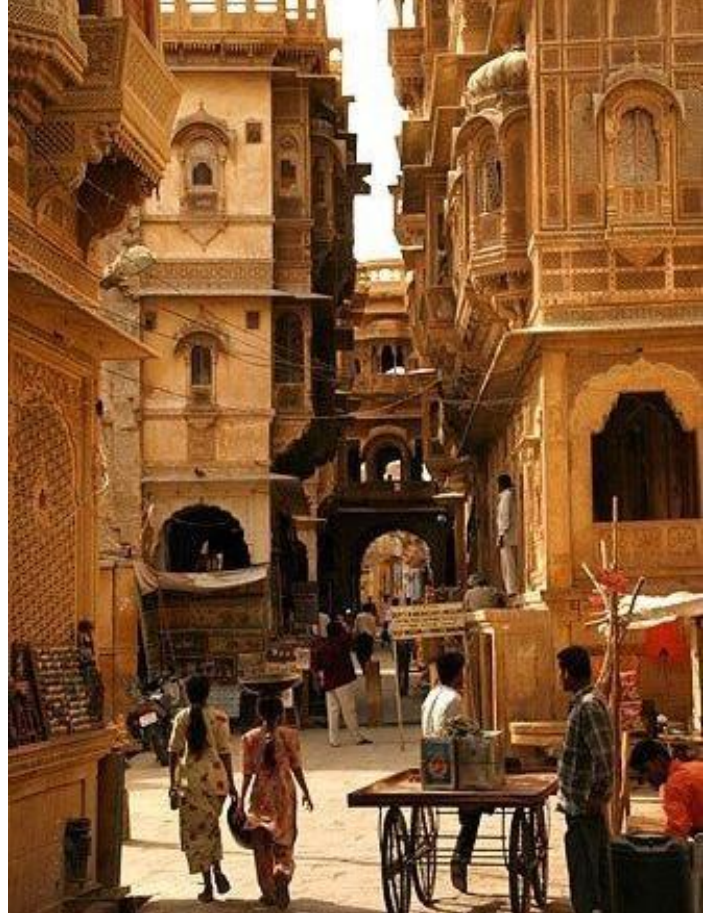


आपल्या धर्माप्रमाणे, संस्कृतीप्रमाणे, परंपरा, चालीरीती ह्यानुसार एका भाषासमाजात भाषा निर्माण होत असते. उष्टं, खरकटं, सोवळं-ओवळं, पुण्य, ओवाळणे, मसाला ह्या संकल्पना आपल्या भाषेत आहेत, पण त्या इतर भाषासमाजात असतीलच असं नाही. ज्या कल्पना-संकल्पनाच अस्तित्वात नसतील तिथे त्यासाठी शब्दही असणार नाहीत. उदाहरणार्थ इंग्रजीत पाप म्हणजे 'सिन', पण 'पुण्य' ही संकल्पना आपल्याकडे वेगळी आहे. नुसतं 'गुड डीड' म्हणून आपली पुण्याची कल्पना अभिव्यक्त होत नाही. आपल्याकडे उपासाचे पदार्थ किंवा सोवळ्यात शिजवलेलं अन्न असतं. हिब्रू भाषेत 'कोशेर' असा एक शब्द अन्नाच्या संदर्भात वापरतात. जुन्या ज्यू धर्माच्या नियमानुसार तयार केलेलं अन्न. इझ्राईलमध्ये काही 'कोशेर' उपहारगृह असतात, तशी ती ज्यू वस्तीत अमेरिकेत, जर्मनीत वगैरेही असतात.

आता सीमा, राष्ट्रवाद, पाऊस, भात, गाय ह्या संकल्पना सार्वत्रिक आहेत आणि त्या अनेक भाषांमध्ये शब्दांनी व्यक्त होत असतात. पण ह्या अर्थाच्या इंग्रजी किंवा जर्मन शब्दांना संदर्भ मात्र वेगळे असतात. गाईला आपल्या संस्कृतीत फार मोठं आणि महत्वाचं स्थान आहे. जर्मनमध्ये मात्र एखाद्या मुलीला बावळट, वेडी असं म्हणायचं असेल, तर 'काय गाय आहे' असं म्हणतात!

सीमा म्हटलं तर आपल्याला उत्तर सीमेवरचा हिमालय आठवतो. प्रत्येक राष्ट्र सीमेचा अर्थ वेगळा लावतं. आपला राष्ट्रवाद भारत पारतंत्र्यात असतांना उदयाला आला. म्हणून 'राष्ट्रवाद' ही संकल्पना आपल्याकडे बा-याच लोकांना सकारात्मक वाटते. पण जर्मन राष्ट्रवाद एकोणिसाव्या शतकात उदयाला आला आणि नाझी

र्मनीत त्याची परमावधी झाली. इतर वंश, धर्म किंवा राजकीय विरोधक ह्यांना जर्मन राष्ट्रवादाने आक्हेरलं आणि त्यांचा छळ केला किंवा त्यांची हत्या केली गेली. त्यामुळे युद्धोत्तर काळात जर्मनीत 'राष्ट्रवाद' सकारात्मक अर्थाने वापरला जात नाही. तिथे हा शब्द फार जपून वापरला जातो. पावसाचं आपल्या जीवनात आणि साहित्यात जे स्थान आहे त्याहून युरोपीय साहित्यात पावसाचं स्थान वेगळं आहे. अगदी आपल्या संत साहित्यात आणि बायबलमध्येही पाण्याची उपमा अनेक ठिकाणी येते. पण



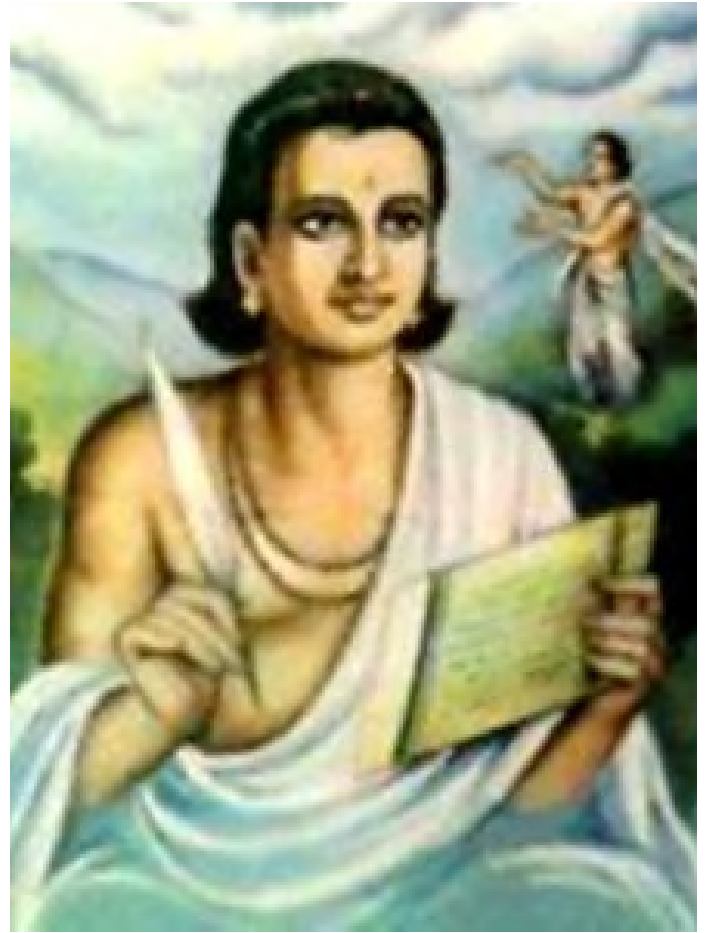
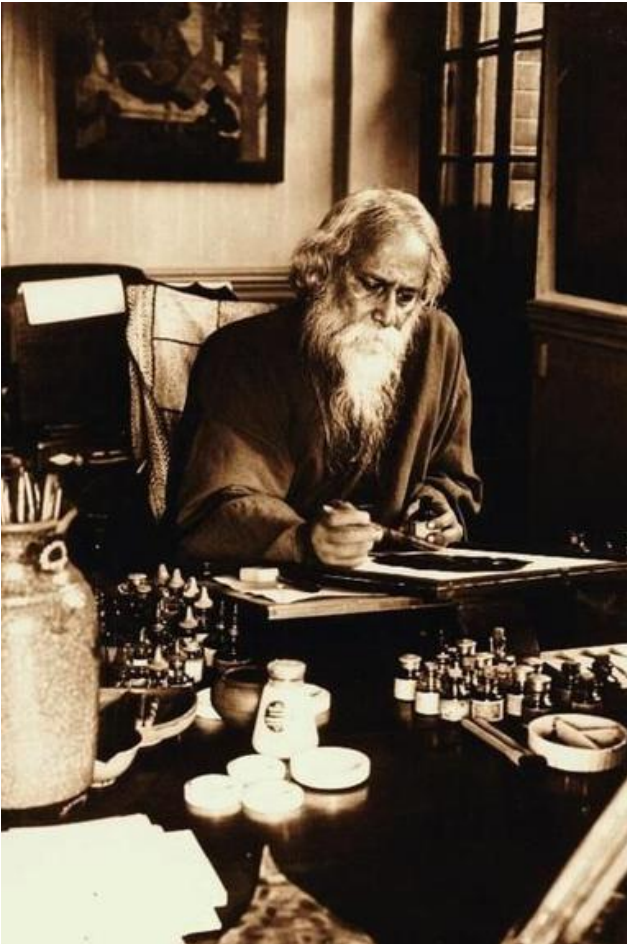
तरी हवामान आणि भौगोलिक परिस्थितीमुळे त्यामागच्या भूमिकांमध्ये फरक पडू शकतो. जर्मन लोक जिथे 'पावसातून पन्हेळी खाली' असा वाकप्रचार वापरतील तिथे आपण 'आगीतून फुफाट्यात' अशी म्हण वापरू. ह्याचा उल्लेख 'भाषेकडे बघताना...' मध्ये आलेला आहे. भाषेचा वापर हा हवामान, भौगोलिक परिस्थिती, सभोवतालचं वातावरण अशा अनेक गोष्टींशी निगडित असतो. पावसातली प्रणयाराधना, विरहिणीची व्याकुळता पाश्चात्य लोकांना कळणं खूप अवघड आहे.

इतकंच काय, साठवलेलं पाणी आणि वाहातं पाणी ह्यांच्या वापरात ललित साहित्यामध्ये फरक पडतो! पावसाचा आणि उत्कट प्रेमाचा, विरहगीतांचा निकटचा संबंध आपल्या साहित्यात दिसतो.



अगदी महाकवी कालिदासापासून, रवींद्रनाथ टागोरांपासून आपल्याला अशी अनेक उदाहरणे मिळतात. शंकर सेन गुप्ता ह्यांचं "rain in Indian life and lore" हे पुस्तक ह्या संदर्भात बघण्यासारखं आहे. त्यात त्यांनी अनेक भारतीय भाषांमधल्या पाऊस-काव्याची उदाहरणे दिली आहेत. पण जर्मन साहित्यामध्ये मात्र नेहमी साठलेल्या पाण्याचा उल्लेख येतो. जर्मनी किंवा इंग्लंडमध्ये कोणीही हौसेनं पावसात भिजत नाही. त्यांना रोजच्या पावसाचा कंटाळाच आलेला असतो. पण एखादी ललना तळ्यात, तलावात किंवा अगदी समुद्रातसुद्धा पोहून किंवा डुबून ओलेती बाहेर येते ती त्या पुरुषांना सगळ्यात आकर्षक वाटते. जलप-यांचा उल्लेख पारंपारिक जर्मन साहित्यात बरेचदा येतो. असा हवामान आणि संस्कृतितला फरक साहित्यात उतरतो. आपण मुंबईमध्ये म्हणा की कोकणात म्हणा 'बीच'वर बरेचदा 'फिरायला' जातो, पोहायला किंवा पाण्यात डुंबायला जात नाही, ह्याच जर्मन लोकांना खूपच आश्चर्य वाटतं.

भाषा ही समाज आणि संस्कृतिनिष्ठ असते. प्रत्येक शब्द हा आशयाने संपृक्त असतो. पुष्कळदा शब्द हे त्यांच्या अर्थाच्या मर्यादित न वापरता काहीतरी सूचित करणारे असे 'निर्देशक' (indicator) म्हणून वापरले जातात.



ह्या संदर्भातली अनेक गंमतशीर उदाहरणे देता येतील. इथे आठवण होते ती सतीश आळेकर यांच्या 'एक झुलता पूल' ह्या एकांकिकेची. ही एकांकिका एके काळी, म्हणजे चाळीस पंचेचाळीस वर्षांपूर्वी, अत्यंत गाजली आणि तिला 'पुरुषोत्तम करंडक'मध्ये अनेक पारितोषिके मिळाली. ह्या एकांकिकेच्या सुरुवातीलाच एक तरुण एका तरुणीला विचारतो 'अहो, तुमच्याकडे प्रेशर कुकर आहे का?' हा अनपेक्षित प्रश्न सुरुवातीला निरर्थक आणि अॅबसर्ड वाटतो. तो तरुण पुढे एकदा त्या तरुणीला म्हणतो, 'मला तुमच्याकडे बघून वाटलंच होतं की तुमच्याकडे प्रेशर कुकर, फ्रीज वगैरे असणार म्हणून. तुम्ही नदीच्या पलीकडे (डेक्कन जिमखान्यामध्ये) राहत असणार, वडलांची गाडी, तुमची स्कूटर, आईची क्लबमध्ये रमी.' म्हणजे त्या काळी 'प्रेशर कुकर' ह्या शब्दांमध्ये त्या युवकाला जीवनाचं हे संबंध चित्र अभिप्रेत होतं! तो मुलगा जुन्या पुण्यात, 'पेठेत' राहात असतो.

पुढे ती मुलगी त्याला विचारते, 'हेवा वाटतो का?' त्यावर तो म्हणतो, 'लक्ष्मीछाप पितळी कुकरला कधी प्रेशर कुकरचा हेवा वाटतो का? कारण दोन्हीत वाफ कोंडते.' म्हणजे हा एक प्रकारे 'प्रेशर कुकर' आणि 'लक्ष्मीछाप पितळी कुकर' च्या तफावतीतला 'झुलता पूल' आहे. इथे 'प्रेशर कुकर' हा

प्रत्येक भाषेत निर्माण झालेल्या नवीन संकल्पना आणि त्यासाठी वापरली जाणारी नवीन भाषा, नवीन शब्द असतात. अलीकडे निर्माण झालेल्या इंग्रजी भाषेतल्या संगणकीय संकल्पना, व्यापार, अर्थ, वित्त तसंच युद्धशास्त्रातल्या संकल्पना ह्या वैश्वीकरणामुळे आणि भाषांतरातून आपल्यापर्यंत पोचतात. पुष्कळदा असं होतं की विविध क्षेत्रातले कित्येक शब्द मूळ भाषेतून तसेच उचलले जातात. उदाहरणार्थ भारतीय भक्ती, योग, कर्म, बुद्ध, निर्वाण; चिनी 'यिंग-यांग'; जपानी कार्यप्रणाली 'कायझेन', जर्मन तत्वाज्ञानातल्या संकल्पना Sein आणि Dasein, इंग्रजीतून Face Book, इत्यादी.





जीवनमानाचा आणि विशिष्ट जीवनपद्धतीचा सूचक किंवा निर्देशक म्हणून वापरला आहे. अशा प्रकारे प्रत्येक शब्दाला एक सामाजिक, सांस्कृतिक संदर्भ असतो आणि शब्दांचे उपयोजन करतांना त्यात एक निर्देशांक अनुस्यूत असतो. प्रत्येक शब्दामध्ये काही जीवनानुभव, सामाजिक परिस्थिती, राजकीय घडामोडी, ऐतिहासिक, पौराणिक, सांस्कृतिक संदर्भ सामावलेले असतात. अगदी भौगोलिक परिस्थितीचाही आपल्या भाषेवर परिणाम होत असतो. प्रत्येक शब्दाचे आपले असं एक संदर्भजग असतं.

भाषावापराचे स्तर

भाषावापराचे अनेक स्तर असतात. म्हणजे आपण ठराविक संदर्भात अनेक समानार्थी शब्दांमधून निवड करून ठराविक शब्द वापरतो. उदाहरणार्थ 'खून' आणि 'हत्या'. किंवा कोणाचे निधन झालं, कोण दिवंगत झालं, स्वर्गवासी झालं, पैगंबरवासी झालं, कोण गेलं, मेलं, कोण धारातीर्थी पडलं, कोण शहीद झालं, अशा शब्दांचा वापर आपण संदर्भाप्रमाणे करतो. 'वसुंधरा हिरवी वसनं ल्याली', 'वसुंधरेनं हिरवी साडी घातली', 'वसुंधरा हिरवं लुगडं नेसून आली' हे वर्णन पावसाळ्यात हिरवा रंग पांघरलेल्या पृथ्वीचं आहे. वरच्या तीन उदाहरणांवरून आपल्याला काय कळतं? पहिल्या उदाहरणात लक्षात येतं की हा वापर काहीशा जुन्या साहित्यातला किंवा काव्यातला आहे. 'वसनं ल्याली' ही भाषा आजच्या तरुण पिढीला कळायला अवघड आहे. दुस-यात जाणवतं की आजची तरुण पिढी 'साडी घालते', 'नेसत नाही'. तिसरं उदाहरण आजीच्या पिढीतलं आहे. 'लुगडं नेसणं' असं आजी म्हणते, इत्यादी. म्हणजे भाषा वापरतांना भाषेचा स्तर, भाषेचं प्रयोजन आणि संदर्भ लक्षात घ्यावेच लागतात.

भाषेची बलस्थानं

प्रत्येक भाषेची आपली ताकद, आपली बलस्थानं असतात. संत वाङ्मय हे मराठी साहित्याच्या इतिहासातलं एक बलस्थान आहे. त्याची म्हणून भाषा आहे, त्याचं एक तत्वज्ञान आहे. त्याचा म्हणून एक आध्यात्मिक विचार आहे, त्याची म्हणून एक सामाजिक जाण आहे. एखाद्या भाषेत नवा मूलभूत विचार निर्माण होतो आणि त्याची अभिव्यक्ती होते, तेव्हा ते त्या भाषेचं बलस्थान बनतं आणि अनेक अंगांनी ती भाषा समृद्ध करतं.

प्रत्येक भाषेचा वेगळा दृष्टिकोन

प्रत्येक भाषा आणि भाषासमाज आपल्या नजरेतून जग न्याहाळत असतो. त्यानुसारच भाषेतून अभिव्यक्ती होत असते. एक साधसं उदाहरण घेऊ या. महाराष्ट्रातला माणूस म्हणेल 'ऑक्टोबरमध्ये फार गरम असतं.' तर जर्मन माणूस म्हणेल, 'ऑक्टोबरमध्ये थंडी असते.' ही दोन्ही वाक्यं त्या त्या परिस्थितीनुसार खरी असतात. कारण जर्मनीमध्ये ऑक्टोबर महिन्यात कधी तरी बर्फही पडतं. आपल्याला माहीतच आहे की, एखादा 'आतंकवादी' त्याच्या देशात 'शहीद' किंवा हिरो म्हणून ओळखला जातो.

म्हणूनच भाषाशास्त्रज्ञांच्या मते एकाच भाषेत तंतोतंत जुळणारे समानार्थी शब्द नसतात आणि दोन भाषांमध्ये तंतोतंत जुळणारे प्रतिशब्द नसतात. ह्याचं कारण म्हणजे प्रत्येक शब्दाच्या अर्थाचा आवाका (semantic field), त्याचं उपयोजन आणि उपयोजनात अनुस्यूत असलेले सगळे संदर्भ एकच नसतात. अगदी ऊन, पाऊस, देव, मरण, अशा वैश्विक संकल्पनासुद्धा प्रत्येक भाषेत वेगळे संदर्भ घेऊन येतात आणि म्हणून वेगळा अर्थ प्रतीत करतात.

सगळ्यात महत्वाचा मुद्दा म्हणजे प्रत्येक भाषा म्हणजे एक ज्ञानभांडार असतं. भारतीय परंपरेतली अनेक उदाहरणं देता येतील. वानगीदाखल वैदिक आणि अभिजात संस्कृत साहित्य, संगीतातले राग, अद्वैत तत्त्वज्ञान, गीता, पाणिनीचं व्याकरण, भक्ती परंपरा, योग परंपरा, दलित चळवळ, असहकार आणि सत्याग्रह विचार, स्वातंत्र्य चळवळ, इत्यादी.

LANGUAGE, CONCEPTS, AND CULTURE

Emotions and lack of language

We know how important words are in language. We experience the emotions expressed in words through daily conversation and speech, especially through poetry or songs. How popular is the type of song 'Bhavgeet' in Marathi! We also know how much impact words have. Some words are pleasant, and some are sharp like arrows. According to the emotion in the word, the word has its value, texture, weight, and value. People use words according to that.

But many times the 'lack' of words is also felt. Even people who can use language skilfully often have to search a lot for the right word. Sometimes the right word is not found. Then the writer or poet creates new words or sometimes even destroys the language. Every popular language may have many such limitations! Words can be used in many ways.

We know that sometimes what cannot be achieved through speech is achieved through silence. It cannot be put into words. This is also the limitation of language, and silence is a means of expression!

Language and Culture

Language and culture are inextricably linked. Every language has its own personality, and every word in a language is full of contexts.

Words have many references to politics, religion, religious beliefs, history, geography, climate, traditions, customs, festivals, etc. 'Amchhe Deva-yat hai dha dha dha.' This plural sentence seems strange to many speakers because they do not believe in different gods. 'Parva ay dha What do we remember when we say 'saffron'? First of all, the saffron flag. Shivaji, Swarajya. If we say 'shendri', we will remember the Maruti decorated with vermilion. If we say 'keshari,' we will remember saffron rice and saffron milk.



And we cannot change these pairs. We do not use 'keshari' Maruti, saffron rice, and 'shendri' flags. All words like 'tricolour,' 'valvan,' 'kamal,' 'niranjan,' 'durva,' 'maya,' 'samadhi,' and 'vatsalya' have many cultural references. Such concepts are not necessarily expressed in other languages. 'Vatsalya' means 'mother's love for children'—in a foreign language, 'vatsalya' will have to be described and explained like this. A language is created in a language community according to our religion, culture, tradition, and customs. The concepts of 'ushta,' 'kharkat,' 'sowal-oval,' 'punya,' 'oval,' and 'masala' are in our language, but they are not necessarily in other language communities. Where ideas and concepts do not exist, there will be no words for them. For example, in English, 'sin is 'sin,' but we have a different concept of 'virtue.' Our idea of virtue is not expressed simply as 'good deed.' We have fasting foods or food cooked in a kosher. In Hebrew, a word called 'kosher' is used in the context of food. Food prepared according to the rules of the old Jewish religion. There are some 'kosher' restaurants in Israel, as well as in Jewish settlements in America, Germany, etc.

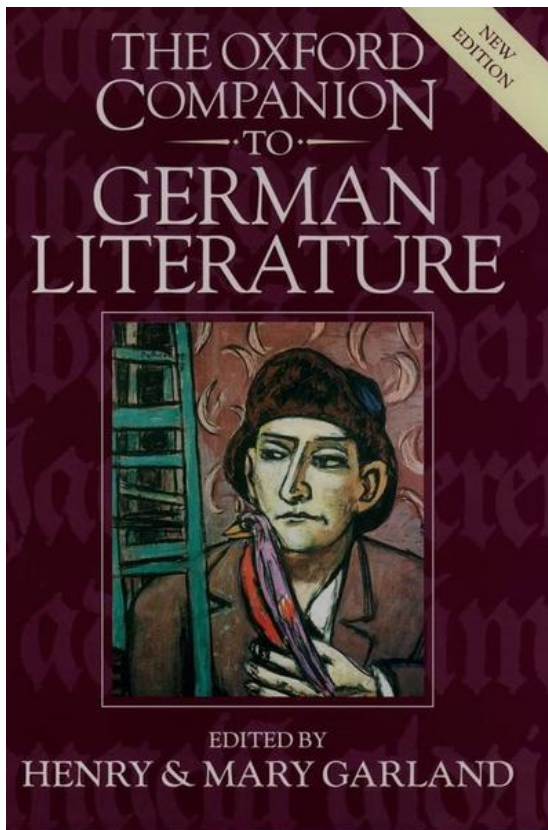
Now the concepts of border, nationalism, rain, rice, and cow are universal and are expressed in words in many languages. But the contexts of English or German words with this meaning are different. Cow has a very big and important place in our culture. However, in German, if you want to call a girl crazy, you say 'What a cow'!

When we say border, we remember the Himalayas on the northern border. Each nation interprets borders differently. Our nationalism emerged when India was under independence. Therefore, the concept of 'nationalism' seems positive to many people in our country. But German nationalism emerged in the nineteenth century and reached its peak in Nazi Germany. Other races, religions, or political opponents were embraced by German nationalism and were persecuted or killed. Therefore, 'nationalism' is not used in a positive sense in Germany in the post-war period. The word is used very cautiously there.

The place of rain in European literature is different from the place it has in our lives and literature. Even in our saint literature and the Bible, the metaphor of water appears in many places. However, the role behind it can differ due to the climate and geographical conditions. Where the Germans use the idiom 'raindrops falling from the sky,' we use the proverb 'fire blowing.' This is mentioned in 'Looking at the language...'. The use of language is related to many things such as the climate, geographical conditions, and the surrounding environment. It is very difficult for Westerners to understand the love of rain, the anguish of a bereaved wife.

Moreover, there is a difference in the use of stored water and flowing water in fine literature! The close relationship between rain and passionate love and songs of separation is seen in our literature. We get many such examples from the great poets Kalidasa and Rabindranath Tagore. Shankar Sen Gupta's book "Rain in Indian Life and Lore" is worth reading in this context. In it, he has given examples of rain poetry in many Indian languages.





But in German literature, however, the accumulated water is always mentioned. In Germany or England, no one gets wet in the rain. They are tired of the daily rain. But a girl who comes out wet after swimming or diving in a pond, lake or even the sea, is the most attractive to those men. The mention of water is often found in traditional German literature. Such a difference in climate and culture is reflected in literature. Germans are very surprised that we often go to the 'beach' in Mumbai or Konkan but do not go swimming or diving in the water.

Language is social and cultural. Every word is saturated with meaning. Often, words are used as 'indicators' that indicate something without using them within the limits of their meaning.

Many funny examples can be given in this regard. Here I remember Satish Alekar's one-act play 'Ek Zhulta Pool.'. This one-act play was very popular once, that is, forty-five years ago, and it received many awards in the 'Purushottam Karandak'. At the beginning of this one-act play, a young man asks a young woman, 'Hey, do you have a pressure cooker?' This unexpected question seems meaningless and absurd at first. The young man later says to the young woman, 'I thought by looking at you that you would have a pressure cooker, a fridge, etc. You must be living across the river (in Deccan Gymkhana), with your father's car, your scooter, and your mother's rummy in the club.' That is, at that time, the words 'pressure cooker' meant this entire picture of life to the young man! The boy lives in old Pune, in the 'pethe.'

The girl then asks him, 'Do you feel jealous?' To which he says, 'Does a Laxmichhap brass cooker ever feel jealous of a pressure cooker? Because both of them produce steam.' In other words, this is a kind of 'suspension bridge' between 'pressure cooker' and 'Laxmichhap brass cooker.'. Here, 'pressure cooker' is used as an indicator of the standard of living and a specific way of life. In this way, every word has a social and cultural context,

and when a word is used, an index is attached to it. Every word contains some life experience, social situation, political event, historical, mythological, or cultural context. Even geographical conditions affect our language. Every word has its world of reference.

Levels of Language Usage

There are many levels of language usage. That is, we use certain words by choosing from many synonyms in a specific context. For example, 'murder' and 'murder.'. Or we use words like 'who passed away, who passed away, who went to heaven, who became a prophet, who went, died, who fell on the



path of Dharatirthi, who became a martyr, according to the context. 'Vasundhara has covered the earth with green spring,' 'Vasundhara has put on a green saree,' and 'Vasundhara has put on green clothes' are descriptions of the earth covered with green during the monsoon. What do we learn from the above three examples? In the first example, it is clear that this usage is from some old literature or poetry. The language 'vasan lyali' is difficult for today's young generation to understand. In the second, it is clear that today's young generation 'wears a saree' and 'does not wear it.'. The third example is from my grandmother's generation. 'Putting on clothes,' says Aji, etc. That is, while using language, one has to keep in mind the level of language, the purpose of language, and the context.

Strengths of language

Every language has its strengths. Saint literature is a strength in the history of Marathi literature. It has a language; it has a philosophy. It has a spiritual thought; it has a social consciousness. When a new fundamental thought is created and expressed in a language, it becomes the strength of that language and enriches that language in many ways.

The tradition of German philosophy in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, the philosophy of Marx, the development of automobiles in the twentieth century, the German and Russian language arrangements in linguistics, the tradition of French structuralism, and European postmodernism, etc. These are the stores of knowledge accumulated in that language. With such research and new systems, new vocabulary develops.

Different perspectives of each language

Each language and language community sees the world through its own eyes. Accordingly, language is used to express itself.

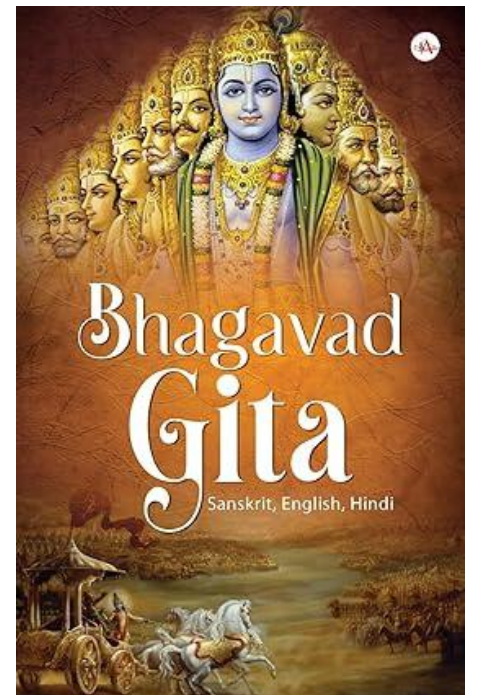
Let's take a simple example. A person from Maharashtra will say, 'It is very hot in October.' While a German will say, 'It is cold in October.' Both these sentences are true depending on the situation. Because in Germany, it sometimes snows in October. As we know, a 'terrorist' is known as a 'martyr' or hero in his country.

That is why, according to linguists, there are no exact synonyms in one language and no exact antonyms in two languages. The reason for this is that the semantic field of the meaning of each word, its application, and all the contexts implied in the application are not the same. Even universal concepts like sun, rain, God, and death, bring different contexts in each language and therefore have different meanings.

The most important point is that each language is a storehouse of knowledge. Many examples can be given from the Indian tradition. For example, Vedic and classical Sanskrit literature, ragas in music, Advaita philosophy, Gita, Panini's grammar, Bhakti tradition, Yoga tradition, Dalit movement, non-cooperation and Satyagraha thought, freedom movement, etc. In every language, new concepts are created, and new language is used for them; new words are created. Recently, concepts of computer science, trade, economics, finance, and military science in English have reached us due to globalisation and translation. It often happens that many words from various fields are also taken from the original language. For example, Indian devotion, yoga, karma, Buddha, nirvana;

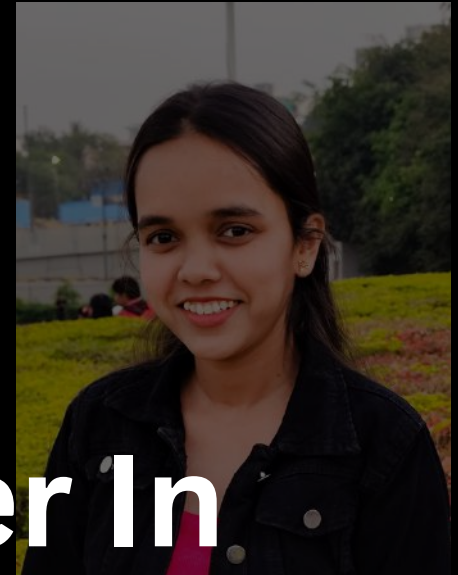
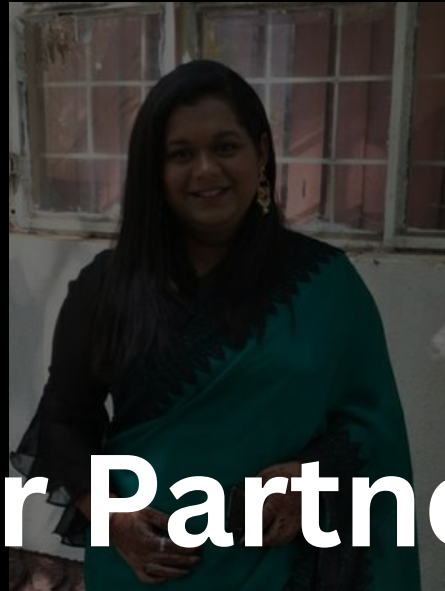
Chinese 'ying-yang'; Japanese work system 'kaizen'; concepts of Sein and Dasein in German philosophy; Facebook from English, etc. In this way, language is related to culture. Independent concepts, thoughts, and viewpoints are created from its soil. Language is mainly enriched by the arrangement of such basic ideas. Every language has its unique perspective on the world around it, its hairstyle, and its language. It has its reality and its truth!!

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